

Raven Cruz

(916) 578-7195 | ravencruzruiz@gmail.com | Relocating to New York, NY
corvuscorae.github.io/portfolio | github.com/corvuscorae

SUMMARY

Game developer and designer with a B.S. in Computer Science (Game Design) from UC Santa Cruz. Experienced creating interactive projects that combine programming, visual design, storytelling, and generative systems. 5+ years of experience with Adobe Photoshop and Lightroom, with familiarity in Premiere Pro. Two years of research experience designing co-creative tools, building AI training and evaluation workflows, and communicating technical findings through peer-reviewed publications. Comfortable moving between creative concepts, prototypes, and production-ready implementation in cross-disciplinary teams.

SKILLS & QUALIFICATIONS

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML5, C++, C#, Lua

Creative & Design: Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Lightroom, Premiere Pro, interactive design, narrative design, visual development, prototyping

Interactive Development: Godot, Unity, Phaser, procedural generation, level design, behavior-driven systems, JSON-based game/data definitions

AI & Generative Systems: AI workflow prototyping, model output evaluation, LLM training data, procedural content generation, co-creative tools

Tools & Practices: Git, GitHub, Agile, code review, technical writing, cross-disciplinary collaboration

EXPERIENCE

Game Developer & Designer | ToppieTee | Reddit Devvit Games with a Hook Hackathon | 2026

- Designed and built a browser-based golf game for Reddit, combining physics-based play, procedural course generation, daily and practice modes, and an interface designed for desktop and mobile.
- Owned the game concept, interaction design, visual direction, onboarding, and replay structure while iterating under a hackathon deadline.

Game Developer | AstroFrame (UC Santa Cruz Senior Capstone) | Steam Early Access, Summer 2026 | 2026

- Designed and implemented narrative and level systems for a 2D roguelike in Godot, including procedural level generation, game state, dialogue, and spreadsheet-driven JSON tools supporting level state and completion rules.
- Collaborated with a multidisciplinary team to shape a complete, player-ready title for Steam in an Agile-style workflow.

Undergraduate Researcher | UC Santa Cruz | 2024 - 2026

- Collaborated with cross-disciplinary research teams and produced peer-reviewed work communicating technical and design findings clearly to academic audiences.
Published: [Conversational Interactions with Procedural Generators using Large Language Models](#), FDG 2025.
- Designed and built a JavaScript/HTML5 level generator and annotation system that described generated level content in natural language, producing structured training data for LLMs.
- Evaluated model outputs for accuracy and documented where and why the system failed, developing a critical approach to AI-assisted creative workflows.
Published: [SketchTiler: Co-Creative Sketch-to-Tilemap Conversion Using Wave Function Collapse](#), IEEE CoG 2025.
- Built a co-creative sketching interface that translated user drawings into tiled levels using Wave Function Collapse; redesigned the generation workflow using a hierarchical approach, reducing average runtime from about 10s to about 1s.

Course Tutor | UC Santa Cruz | 2025 - 2026

- Provided written and verbal feedback across 5 CS: Game Design courses using JavaScript/HTML5, Phaser, and p5.js. Adapted communication style to students at varying skill levels.
- Diagnosed design and technical issues across unfamiliar projects; translated findings into clear, actionable guidance during code reviews and pair-debugging sessions.

Assistant Manager | Crossroads Trading Co. | July 2017 - January 2021

- Led cross-functional teams, authored operational documentation, and trained staff at multiple levels in a fast-paced, independently managed environment.

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science: Game Design | UC Santa Cruz | *Dean's Honors* | March 2026

A.S. Computer Science & A.S. Mathematics | American River College | *Highest Honors* | May 2023